ROLEEDGE · CONSULTING PREP

Case Interview Guide

Frameworks, Practice, and Confidence to Crack Consulting Interviews

13	10	Print
SECTIONS	EXERCISES	WITH SPACE TO WRITE

> **How to use this guide:** print it, work through it in order, and write in the spaces. Every exercise has room for your answers, and you can print extra copies of any page.

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From **RoleEdge**, founded by Mayank Kapoor, former Manager at Bain & Company and Warwick MBA. Free to use and share.

Why Case Interviews Matter

Consulting interviews are unlike standard job interviews. They test how you **think, structure, and communicate.** Recruiters want to see:

- Logical problem-solving.
- Comfort with ambiguity.
- Business intuition + math.

It's not about knowing the "right answer." It's about your **framework and clarity.**

EXERCISE

Write down 2 reasons why you want to join consulting.

1. _____

2. _____

Anatomy of a Case Interview

A case has 4 parts:

- **Prompt:** Client problem statement.
- **Clarifying Questions:** Show curiosity & structure.
- **Framework:** Lay out approach (MECE).
- **Analysis & Recommendation:** Do math + give final recommendation.

EXAMPLE

"A hotel chain's profits are declining. Diagnose and recommend."

The MECE Mindset for Structuring

MECE = Mutually Exclusive, Collectively Exhaustive.

- Profitability = Revenues vs Costs.
- Market Entry = Market, Competition, Customers, Product, Financials.

EXERCISE

Take the prompt “Client wants to enter EV market.” Write a MECE breakdown.

Profitability Framework

When profits drop, check:

- **Revenues:** Price, volume, product mix.
- **Costs:** Fixed vs variable.
- **External factors:** Regulations, competitors.

MINI CASE

A gym chain’s profit margins fall despite constant membership. What do you check first?

Market Entry Framework

Market entry = Is it attractive, and can we win?

- **Market Attractiveness:** Size, growth, profitability.
- **Competitive Landscape:** Players, market share.
- **Client Capabilities:** Brand, resources, distribution.
- **Entry Strategy:** Build, buy, or partner.

MINI CASE

An FMCG firm wants to enter bottled water in Vietnam. What factors do you analyze?

M&A & Synergy Framework

M&A cases test valuation + synergies.

- **Strategic Fit:** Why buy?
- **Synergies:** Revenue ↑ or costs ↓.
- **Risks:** Culture, integration, regulation.

MINI CASE

A tech firm wants to acquire a smaller AI startup. How do you assess value?

Operations & Supply Chain Framework

Ops cases test efficiency.

- **Supply side:** Procurement, production.
- **Process side:** Bottlenecks, utilization.
- **Delivery side:** Logistics, distribution.

MINI CASE

A factory runs at 60% utilization. What steps to improve efficiency?

Guesstimates & Market Sizing

Guesstimates test structured thinking. Example: Estimate Uber rides/day in Delhi.

- Population → % using Uber → Avg. rides.

Clear segmentation + assumptions = strong answer.

EXERCISE

Estimate toothpaste market size in India.

Case Math: Margins, Breakevens, CAGR

EXAMPLE

Revenue = ₹100 Cr, Costs = ₹70 Cr → Profit Margin = 30%.

BEP = Fixed Costs ÷ Contribution Margin.

CAGR = (End/Start)^(1/n) – 1.

EXERCISE

A firm's revenue grew from $100M to $200M in 3 years. What's the CAGR? (Answer: about 26%.)

Communication & Hypothesis-Driven Thinking

Case success = structure + clarity. Always:

- Start with hypothesis ("I believe the issue is pricing.").
- Test hypothesis with data.
- Pivot when evidence contradicts.

EXERCISE

Write a hypothesis for: "A restaurant's revenues are declining."

Five Practice Cases

1. ☐ **Retail:** Clothing retailer's sales flat. Diagnose.
2. ☐ **Banking:** Bank wants to launch credit cards. Analyze.
3. ☐ **Healthcare:** Pharma firm's drug patent expiring. What next?
4. ☐ **Tech:** SaaS startup sees customer churn rising. Diagnose.
5. ☐ **Travel:** Airline sees falling profits despite full planes. Why?

Pick one and solve it in 20 minutes using a MECE structure. Tick each case once you've tried it.

WORKSHEET

The case I chose, and my structure:

EXAMPLE

Worked examples

An illustrative example. Names and details are representative, not real clients.

Profitability case: The candidate found that logistics made up 60% of costs after fuel price rises, and recommended renegotiating contracts, worth about ₹50 Cr to the client.

Market entry case: The candidate structured EV entry into Middle East, analyzed regulation + demand. Recommendation: enter UAE first, then scale.

> LESSON
>
> Frameworks + clarity win.

Common Mistakes and a 12-Week Plan

- ✕ Jumping into math before framework.
- ✕ Listing random factors without structure.
- ✕ Weak recommendations ("It depends").

Your plan

When	Focus	My actions
Weeks 1–4	Framework drills.	
Weeks 5–8	Guesstimates + case math.	
Weeks 9–12	Full mock cases + feedback.	

My notes

NEXT STEP

Want someone to check your work?

Bring this guide to a free call with RoleEdge. We'll go through your answers and help you plan what comes next.

Book a free call at roleedge.com/book